BrightTime

DOCUMENTATION

Guide for Families

Finding activities, your account, and your children’s profiles and consent

For parents and guardians

BrightTime is a countywide platform for out-of-school time. Families and young people find after-school, summer and weekend activities; the organisations that run them take registrations and record attendance; and the county's network organisers vet every organisation and listing.

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CHAPTER 1

BrightTime for families

This guide is for parents and guardians. It covers finding activities, your account, and your children's profiles and consent. Young people with their own account have their own guide.

Finding activities

You don't need an account to search.

On the website, start from the home page or **Search**:

- Type what you're looking for, such as *robotics*, *swim* or *homework help*. Small spelling mistakes are forgiven.
- Narrow the results by **age**, **kind of listing** (programs, events, drop-in resources, jobs and internships), **neighbourhood**, **highest price** or **free only**.
- Sort by **best match**, **starts soonest**, **nearest** (once you've chosen a neighbourhood) or **newest**.
- Show the results as a **list** or a **map** of the county's neighbourhoods.

Every filter is in the page's address, so you can bookmark a search or send it to someone. The site also has **collections** (activities a network organiser has grouped, such as *Summer camps*), a page for each **neighbourhood** with what's on there this week, and a page for each **organisation**.

In the app, tap the search box, then the filters. The app adds a few more filters: **drop in, no sign-up**, **food provided** and **transport provided**. **Near me** uses your phone's location once to pick the closest neighbourhood. Your location isn't kept.

A listing's page tells you what it is, who it's for (ages and grades), when it meets (in local time), where, how much it costs, which languages are spoken, and access details such as wheelchair access, meals and transport. Under **How to join** it says what to do:

- *Just come along*, for drop-in activities;
- register on the organisation's own website;
- contact the organisation; or
- *Registration through BrightTime opens soon*, for programs that will take applications here. Until then, contact the organisation to save a place.

Some places show only the neighbourhood, not the street address, for example a program held in a shelter. The exact address is shared once you register.

Saving activities and reminders

- **On the website**, tap **Save** on any listing. Saved activities are kept **in this browser only**, so anyone else using it can see them. The **Saved** page groups them by deadline, and **Add reminders to your calendar** downloads a calendar file that reminds you a day before each deadline and an hour before each session. BrightTime doesn't keep your contact details for this.
- **In the app**, sign in to save. Saved activities follow your account to any phone or tablet, and the app keeps your last list for when you're offline. On a listing you can also ask to be reminded **a day before the deadline** or **an hour before it starts**.

Your feed, interests and area (app)

Once you're signed in, the app's home page is **Picked for you**. Each card says why it was shown, for example *matches 2 of your interests* or *starts in 3 days*.

- **Your interests** (under **Account**) are put first in your feed. They are the only preference of yours the feed uses, and you can change them whenever you like.
- **Your area** is the neighbourhood your feed searches from. Choose one, or tap **Use my location** to pick the closest. BrightTime never keeps your address or where you are.

Notifications (app)

The **Inbox** holds every notification BrightTime sends you. Under **Account** → **Notifications** you choose, for each kind (session reminders, deadline reminders, changes to saved activities, new messages), whether it reaches you **in your inbox**, **on your phone** or **by email**.

Quiet hours stop your phone showing notifications between two times you choose. They still go to your inbox.

Email notifications aren't sent yet: for now, choose the inbox or your phone.

Your account

Creating an account. In the app, tap **Create an account**, or use the website's sign-in page:

1. Say the month and year you were born. BrightTime never asks for the day. Adults' accounts don't keep it at all.
2. Give your email address. We send a link to choose a password.
3. Open the link, choose a password, and sign in.

Someone under 13 can't make an account. A parent or guardian adds them to their own account instead (see below).

Signing in. Use a **passkey** if your phone or computer has one, or your email address and password. Your county may also offer sign-in with another account, such as Google.

Passkeys let you sign in with your phone's fingerprint, face or screen lock instead of a password. Add one under **Account** → **Passkeys** in the app, or **Sign-in and security** on the website. You can remove any passkey there too.

Forgot your password? Use **Forgot your password?** on the sign-in page. We email a link to choose a new one. For your safety, the page says the same thing whether or not the address has an account.

Changing your password or your sign-in methods on the website asks you to confirm who you are again if you last did so more than a few minutes ago.

Sign out on all devices, under **Account** in the app, ends your sessions everywhere, for example after losing a phone.

Terms of use. You can read the terms at any time on the website's **Terms** page or in the app. Agreeing to them is needed before you sign up for programs yourself.

Children's profiles and consent (app)

Children under 13 don't have accounts of their own. You add them to yours, under **Your family** in the app.

Adding a child.

1. Tap **Add a child**.
2. Give their **first name or nickname**, the **month and year they were born**, and **your relationship** to them. BrightTime keeps nothing else: no last name, no birthday.
3. We email you a link. **Open it to give your consent.** Until then the profile shows as *Waiting for your consent* and can't be used.

The link opens in the app if it's installed, or on the website, where you sign in as yourself to confirm.

Each child's page shows their consents, one per thing they cover:

Consent	Lets your child…
Using BrightTime	use the platform at all
Signing up for programs	be signed up for programs
Messages from programs	receive messages from programs
Taking part in groups	take part in group spaces
Uploading photos of their work	add photos of what they make
Showing their work publicly	have their work shown publicly
Attendance photos	appear in attendance photos
Using their location	use location features
Sharing with their school district	have information shared with their school district
Use in research	be included in research

To give one, tap **Read and give consent**. You see the exact words you're agreeing to, and BrightTime records that you agreed to those words. **Withdraw consent** takes it back at any time.

Some consents disclose more about a child, and need a **signed form** instead of an email. The app says so. Ask the program or your network organiser for the form. Once they've checked it, the consent shows as given.

Stop managing this profile ends every consent you gave for that child.

Your child's account can do only what you've consented to. Their profile's state is one of: *Ready to use*, *Waiting for your consent*, *Paused until you give consent*, or *Has their own sign-in*.

Giving a child their own sign-in at 13

When a child on your account turns 13, they can have their own sign-in. On their page, choose **Give them their own sign-in** and enter their email address. We email them a link to choose a password; then they sign in themselves. You can still manage their consents.

Your household (app)

Under **Account**, choose **Your household**. You enter your household once, and every program you apply to uses it.

- **About your household**: how many people live in your home, the language spoken there, and whether you need an interpreter.

- **People in your household**: choose **Add someone** for each person: who they are (a child, a young person of 13 or over, a parent or guardian, or another adult), their names, the name they go by, and their relationship to you. A young person's date of birth and school grade matter: programs that check ages see the date of birth, and nobody else does.
- **Support needs**, for a child or young person: an allergy, a medical need, a disability or anything else that helps a program look after them, with a note on what helps. A need is shared only if you tick **Programs may see this**.
- **Their own account**: link a child or young person to the account they use (yours, if this is you, or a child's profile on your account), so the programs they attend and the badges they earn go on their portfolio.
- **Contacts**: people a program can call in an emergency, or who may pick up a child.

Remove from household takes a person off. Programs already sharing their details stop seeing them.

Who can see your household

See who can see it lists every program you've shared your household with: the people, the details, since when, and until when. **Stop sharing** ends a share at once; the program stops seeing those details right away. Shares you stopped, or that ended, stay on the list so you can see what was shared.

Applying (app)

On an activity that takes applications in BrightTime, choose **Apply** (or **Join the waiting list** when it's full). If the activity takes registrations on its own website instead, the button takes you there.

1. **Who it's for.** You see the activity's rules first: ages, school grades, where the young person lives, or a badge they must hold. A rule marked *preferred, not required* never stops anyone applying.
2. **Who is applying.** Choose a child or young person from your household. If you haven't added them yet, you're asked to first. If you've already started an application for them, it opens instead of a second one.
3. **The activity's questions**, in your language where the organisation wrote one. **Save answers** keeps them, and you can come back later. An answer marked *Kept private* never appears in any report.
4. **Waivers**, such as a water-safety form. Read each one; a parent or guardian signs for anyone under 18 by typing their full name. You sign the exact text the organisation published, and if it changes before you sign, you're shown the new text.
5. **What the organisation may see.** The young person's name is always shared. Tick anything else they may see (date of birth, school grade, pronouns, your household's size and language, your contacts, or support needs you marked for programs), and, if you like, a date the share ends. You can stop sharing at any time under **Your household**.
6. **Send the application.**

If the young person doesn't meet a rule that must be met, you're told before you send, and it can't be sent. If a rule can't be checked yet (no school grade, say), you're told which, and can add the details to your household or let the organisation decide.

Your applications, under **Account**, lists each one and where it stands: *Not sent yet*, *Sent*, *Being looked at*, *On the waiting list*, *A place is offered*, *Accepted*, *Not accepted* or *Withdrawn*. When a place is offered from the waiting list, open the application to **Take the place** or **Turn it down**. You can withdraw a sent application, or delete a draft you never sent.

Paying fees (app)

Once a place is offered or accepted, the application shows its **Fees**: each fee, and how often it's charged.

Some fees have lower prices. You see the ones that fit your household's size, and you choose the one that fits; nobody asks your income. If you haven't saved your household's size, saving it may show lower prices.

Choose **Pay this fee**. How you pay depends on your county:

- **By card:** Stripe's secure page opens in your phone's browser. Pay there, then come back to the app and choose **Check again**. Card details never pass through BrightTime. Stripe's page comes in the languages Stripe offers, which may not include yours.
- **Directly to the organisation:** pay by cash, cheque or transfer as it tells you, and it marks the payment received.

The application then shows it as *Paid*. If the organisation waives a fee, it shows *You don't need to pay this*. **Payments so far** lists each payment, its amount and where it stands.

Messages and check-in: coming soon

These are built and being tested, and the screens for families come next. When they arrive you'll be able to:

- **Check in** with a code on your phone that staff scan, and see your child's attendance.
- **Read messages** from your child's programs and their announcements.

Your privacy

- BrightTime never keeps a child's home address or exact location.
- An organisation sees only what you share with it, only while the share lasts, and every time its staff open your details, it's recorded.
- No adult can be alone in a conversation with a young person on BrightTime. An admin of the organisation always reads along, and everyone in the conversation is told so.
- Reports that organisations give funders hide small numbers, so nobody can be picked out.
- Card details never pass through BrightTime.

CHAPTER 2

About BrightTime

BrightTime helps a county's families and young people find things to do outside school, and helps the organisations that run those activities manage them. Each guide below is written for one kind of person.

If you are…	Read
A parent or guardian	Families
13 or over, with your own account	Young people
Someone who runs activities for an organisation	Organisations
A network organiser for the county	Network organisers

One person can be more than one of these. A parent who also coaches a team uses both the families and the organisations guide, with the same account.

Where BrightTime runs

- **The website**, on the county's own address (for the seed region, `kettle.localhost` in development). Anyone can search it without an account, and it works with JavaScript turned off, on a slow connection or an old phone. Organisations and network organisers use its **console**: the pages under *Your organisations*, *Review queue* and the other links that appear once you sign in.
- **The app**, for Android and iOS. It searches the same listings and adds what a phone does well: a personal feed, reminders, notifications, a family's consent centre, and taking attendance without a signal.

Languages

Everything is offered in English, Spanish, Chinese (Simplified), Bengali, Haitian Creole and Arabic. Choose a language at the foot of any web page, or under **Account** in the app. Arabic reads right to left throughout.

The translations are machine drafts until native speakers have reviewed them. A listing that was translated by machine says so.

What is ready, and what is coming

BrightTime is being built in stages. This table says where each part stands today, so that nothing in these guides promises a screen that doesn't exist yet.

	Website	App	Notes
Searching and browsing activities	Yes	Yes	
Saving activities	Yes (this browser only)	Yes (follows your account)	
Accounts, passwords, passkeys	Yes	Yes	
Children's profiles and consent	The consent email's link	Yes	
Agreeing to the terms of use	Yes	Yes	
A personal feed, interests, your area, reminders, notifications		Yes	
Organisations: profile, sites, staff, listings, import	Yes		
Organisations: forms, eligibility, waivers, applications, fees, attendance, messages, reports	Yes		
Organisations: taking attendance on a phone, offline		Yes	
Network organisers: review, taxonomy, wording, audit	Yes		
Families applying to programs and signing waivers	Coming	Yes	
Paying fees, by card on Stripe's page or to the organisation directly	Coming	Yes	
A household's family profile, and choosing and stopping what it shares	Coming	Yes	
Messages from organisations, and a family's own attendance	Coming	Coming	As above
A young person's portfolio, badges and playlists	Coming	Coming	As above
Organisations: playlists	Coming		As above
Organisations: badges	Coming		As above

Where a listing says "*Registration through BrightTime opens soon*", contact the organisation named on it to save a place for now.

Words used in these guides

- **Listing** or **activity**: one thing to do: a program, an event, a drop-in resource, or a job or internship.
- **Organisation**: a group that runs activities. Families sometimes call them providers.
- **Site**: a place where an organisation runs activities.
- **Network organiser**: the county's own staff, who check every organisation and listing before it goes live.
- **Consent**: a parent's or guardian's agreement, given one thing at a time, for a child under 13 to use part of BrightTime.
- **Share**: what a family chooses to let one organisation see about its members, and for how long.